

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Model Risk Management Analyst, AVP candidate with ~7 years across independent model validation, ALM and credit risk modelling, and statistical analysis. At Moody's Analytics, holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios, operating within a formal Model Governance Program – independently reviewing model assumptions, economic defensibility, and stress behaviour prior to production release. Practitioner depth in IFRS 9 transformation (EY) and stochastic scenario modelling (Ortec Finance). CFA charterholder; dual MSc (Financial Modelling, Engineering).

CORE SKILLS

Independent Model Validation & Challenge • Model Risk Management & Governance • Statistical Analysis & Stochastic Modelling • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • IFRS 9 (transformation delivery) • Model Inventory & Annual Review • Validation Reports & Findings Resolution • Python (advanced), R (intermediate), SQL (intermediate) • Stakeholder & Audit Communication

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Independent Model Validation & Governance

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to institutional client portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; ~\$50bn+ cumulative), operating within Moody's formal Model Governance framework.
- Perform independent review and challenge of curve construction, spread calibration, cross-asset interactions, and stress behaviour prior to production release; produce validation reports documenting findings to standards aligned with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations.
- Escalate outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility; manage resolution of findings with model developers and serve as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing with Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Quantitative Modelling & Statistical Analysis

- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation; cross-check sensitivity consistency at portfolio-level aggregates under parallel and non-parallel stress scenarios.
- Led design and implementation of a multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios; embedded behavioural cash flow assumptions, prepayment logic, and macro stress overlays.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation controls, and version tracking.

Documentation & Stakeholder Communication

- Prepared analytical summaries for senior stakeholders covering model outputs, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities – translating quantitative findings into clear narratives for non-technical audiences including risk committees.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and documentation – reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe analytics platform; validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Translated client investment-team requirements into structured Product Owner development requests; advised on asset, liability, and ALM model configurations.

- Contributed to the successful migration of all assigned client accounts from the legacy Calypso platform to PFaroe PM.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 9 and IFRS 17 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients; advised actuarial, IT, finance, and PM functions on standards adoption and governance documentation.
- Contributed to regulatory-readiness processes and developed advisory product offerings for IFRS 17 implementation – coordinating across finance, risk, and IT teams on milestone delivery.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and validated stochastic economic scenario generators using Monte Carlo and statistical methods to assess interest rate, inflation, and funding-volatility risk under base and stressed environments.
- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds; analyzed funding ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet exposures; presented findings to investment committees.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR via Ortec's GLASS platform; conducted risk decomposition, attribution, and near-optimal frontier robustness analysis.
- Led onboarding and ALM study for the University Pension Plan merger (three single-employer plans into a new jointly-sponsored plan) – on a team of three developing and validating the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics and overlay strategies.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016